



Tech glitch: Play was halted during the Pavlyuchenkova-Kartal Round of 16 clash at Wimbledon due to a line-calling system fault. REUTERS

» WIMBLEDON DIARY

Between familiar rituals and unfamiliar calls

From pasta queues to press room rumours and line-calling controversies, the Diary captures Wimbledon 2025's **strange mix** of tradition and disruption.

N. Sudarshan
sudarshan.narayanan@thehindu.co.in

The Diary likes certainty and repeatability. Ever since its first Wimbledon in 2019, it has always filled its stomach in the afternoon with a bowl of pasta and vegetables. It keeps the Diary going for a good six hours — the typical duration of work — considering the deadlines back home in India.

Whenever it enters the media cafeteria, it sees nothing but the pasta counter and the chefs, who

have remained unchanged for the past six years. So, when an 'avocado controversy' hit Wimbledon, the Diary was at first oblivious, but then turned curious.

News agency *Reuters* reported that there were multiple claims suggesting the All England Club had culled avocados from the menu as a sustainability-driven move — given that growing vast amounts of avocados is considered environmentally unsustainable.

The World Avocado Organisation (WAO) sprang to the defence of the beleaguered fruit, stating that such

"misconceptions can have non-desired impacts and affect small farmers who rely on growing avocados to make a living."

Wimbledon clarified that avocados were very much alive and cooking in their kitchens. The Diary, like a true journalist, heard both sides of the story — and then diligently stood in the queue at the pasta counter for one more bowl.

Djokovic, Alcaraz and the full house that wasn't

In the three times the Diary has been to Wimbledon, it has seen the